



## AFTER

The nation was divided. Northerners disagreed among themselves, but a majority opposed the expansion of slavery. Most white Southerners owned no slaves, but were connected to slave society by ties of exchange and kinship.



LINCOLN'S INAUGURATION IN WASHINGTON

## SECESSION AND WAR

Within days of Lincoln's election, **South Carolina** passed a bill scheduling a **secession convention**. On December 20, it **severed its union with the United States** (see [The Union is Dissolved](#)).

In the months between his election and his inauguration on March 4, 1861, Lincoln hoped disunion could be averted. But the day after his inauguration he found a **desperate dispatch** on his desk [from Fort Sumter](#).